

phenotype is the observable set of unique characteristics resulting from the interaction of nature and nurture.

Our Financial Phenotype, meanwhile, is the expression of how we intrinsically behave with money and the influence of our life experience and environment on how we handle our finances. It's the effects of our Money Type, our Money Story and our Money Environment and the suite of habits we've developed as a result, which might be serving us or sabotaging us.

In other words, our Financial Phenotype captures both who we are and why we are, and it helps us to understand why we're behaving the way we are with our finances. Until we understand our Financial Phenotype, we'll continually be caught in a cycle of financial sabotage.

For many of us, the cycle might look like this: frequently worrying about money, avoiding thinking about money and hoping our future self will miraculously sort out our finances, charging the latest yoga retreat or personal training session onto our second credit card and hoping to god it goes through. Patting ourselves on the back because we're embracing minimalism but spending all the money we've saved (and more) on experiences, which is only adding to our anxiety so we reach for another glass of wine, which turns into a regular habit, so we book another retreat, or another detox. Having the best intentions of doing right by the planet but unable to break our addiction to fast fashion, fast food, multiple devices and petrol-guzzling toys. Having a large amount of money in the bank but being unable to do anything of value with it because we're suffering paralysis by analysis so we just work harder and longer and hope that's enough. Permanently being in rescue mode for those around us but never being able to place the financial oxygen mask onto ourselves so we're constantly in a state of financial stress. Feeling obligated to financially behave a particular way but it feels like an itchy jacket we want to throw off, so we sabotage and financially act out. And the cycle continues.

Imagine if you could step off that financial merry-go-round and walk down a path of your own making towards financial wellness.

I believe that until we understand our Financial Phenotype and learn to act so our Money Story and Money Type serve us rather than sabotage us, we'll never be financially well. Money will be something we're constantly battling with, avoiding or forever popping on a 'too hard' list. Or perhaps